

Data SE Briefing — 2026-06-05

Executive Summary

Rayfin is the story of the cycle: Microsoft's new managed backend-as-a-service repositions Fabric from an analytics platform into a runtime for building and running AI-native apps. Databricks published a financial-services guide for its Jun 15-18 Data + AI Summit, a directly useful prep resource for an insurance book of business. Governance of semantic models is heating up across vendors (Alation, Snowflake Horizon), reinforcing the "context layer for AI" theme behind Microsoft IQ.

What I'd Do Today

- Build a Fabric + Rayfin agentic-app demo so you can show, not just describe, Fabric as an app runtime in your next customer sync.
- Review the Databricks FSI Summit guide and flag sessions relevant to your insurance accounts before the Jun 15-18 event.
- Prepare a Purview/OneLake governance counter-narrative to Snowflake Horizon Catalog and Alation Semantic Model Mastering for data-agent grounding conversations.

Account Opportunity Matches

Account names and internal M365 signals are redacted in this public sample. In a real run, each match cites a real email, chat, or meeting from your own mailbox.

- **[Account A — Insurance] — AtScale Extends Snowflake Semantic Views to Power BI and Excel via XMLA Endpoint**
 - Why them: Active Snowflake-to-Fabric work surfaced in a recent internal mirroring/troubleshoot session and a recurring Fabric sync.
 - Suggested play: Frame the XMLA/semantic-views option as an alternative to mirroring; bring a Snowflake expert to the next sync.
 - Confidence: High.

- **[Account B — Insurance] — Rayfin: managed backend-as-a-service for developers and coding agents**
 - Why them: A recent internal Fabric + Purview thread shows active Fabric plus governance interest.
 - Suggested play: Send the Rayfin/Fabric agentic-app overview and propose a combined Fabric + Purview governance session.
 - Confidence: High.
- **[Account C — Insurance] — Data + AI Summit 2026: Insider's Guide for Financial Services Leaders**
 - Why them: An open support thread indicates an active Databricks workload.
 - Suggested play: Once the ticket clears, share the FSI Summit guide and flag insurance sessions relevant to their build.
 - Confidence: Medium.

Microsoft Fabric & Power BI

- **Rayfin: managed backend-as-a-service for developers and coding agents** — Authoritative reference on Rayfin (available as an SDK or on Fabric); the cornerstone of the Fabric agentic-app story and your go-to link when customers ask what it is. Source: *Microsoft*.
- **Rayfin signals Microsoft's push to make Fabric an AI app runtime** — Analyst read framing Rayfin as Fabric's move from analytics platform to a place to build and run AI-native apps. Source: *InfoWorld*.
- **AtScale Extends Snowflake Semantic Views to Power BI and Excel via XMLA Endpoint** — Governed Snowflake metrics reach Power BI and Excel over XMLA without mirroring data; useful semantic-model and Fabric–Snowflake interop context. Source: *AtScale*.

Azure Data Platform

- **Data + AI Summit 2026: Insider's Guide for Financial Services Leaders** — FSI guide (banking, insurance, payments) ahead of the Jun 15-18 Summit, citing Morgan Stanley and JPMorganChase; strong prep for insurance accounts. Source: *Databricks*.

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Data + AI Integration

- **Alation Introduces Semantic Model Mastering** — Central governance for semantic models as cross-platform data products; sits directly adjacent to Fabric semantic models and the Microsoft IQ context-layer theme. Source: *Alation*.

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Broader Data Ecosystem

- **Built-In Data Governance and Discovery with Snowflake Horizon Catalog** — Snowflake's governance and discovery catalog for enterprise AI; a competitive read against Purview/OneLake governance for data-agent grounding. Source: *Snowflake*.
- **Apache Iceberg 1.11.0 Release** — Upstream release adds REST catalog, manifest and table encryption, and a pluggable File Format API; shapes OneLake shortcut and Fabric-Databricks-Snowflake interop. Source: *Apache Iceberg*.

AI Dev-Tools Watch

- **Claude Code has an MCP security problem — and your developers are already using it** — Security caution on MCP in agentic coding; relevant as MCP spreads into data tooling and customer dev workflows. Source: *CSO Online*.

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